

sheriff of Kent in 53 Henry III., and the two following years; and in 55 or 56 Henry III. was appointed constable of Dover Castle and warden of the Cinque Ports, posts for which he received 30*l.* a year to cover the expenses of chaplains and servants, and which he retained as late as 33 Edward I.¹ There are several instances of his being assigned to try malefactors and to decide rights within his jurisdiction², but none that show him to have been one of the regular judges.

His second wife was Margaret, one of the three daughters and coheirs of John de Burgh, the grandson of Hubert de Burgh. Hasted says that after his death she married Robert de Orreby, but it is evident that Orreby must have been her first husband. Stephen de Penecestre was alive in 1305, 33 Edward I., and Margaret on her death in 1309, 2 Edward II., is described by his name; and further, John de Orreby, "son of Margaret, who was the wife of Stephen de Penecestre deceased," did homage for her lands in Kent in the same year, when, if there had been a subsequent marriage, he could not have been more than three years old. Stephen de Penecestre left two daughters and coheirs; Joane, married to Henry de Cobbeham of Rundall; and Alice, married to John de Columbers. He largely endowed the Free Chapel of his manor of Penshurst, and lies buried in the church there under an altar tomb, on which he is represented in armour, and not in judicial robes.³

¹ Excerpt. e Rot. Fin. ii. 552.; Madox's Exch. i. 613.; Abb. Rot. Orig. i. 47.

² Rot. Parl. i. 3. 18. 98. 126.; Abbrev. Placit. 903.

³ Hasted's Kent, i. 182., iii. 75. 231. 255. 259. 272., iv. 450., vi. 84.; Abbrev. Rot. Orig. i. 162. 164.